

Core Values

TODO

2021-06-29

Overview

Ethics background required: None

This module is designed to help students identify their values and how choices may reflect those values.

Subject matter referred to in this module: None

Placement in overall ethics curriculum:

Academic year: First semester of first year. Good first semester module.

Recommended previous modules: Why Ethics? Module

Recommended follow-up modules: Virtue Ethics with Coding Scenarios Module

Time required:

- Out of class: None (but potential online version available if unable to do in class)
- In class: 20 minutes

Learning objectives:

By the end of this module, students will be able to

- identify their own values
- recognize others may have different values
- articulate a value and its application to decision making.

Module overview:

Ethical dilemma or issue considered:

This is an introductory module. The module is designed for students to reflect on their values, articulate what might influence a choice and introduce the awareness that

others may hold different values. The discussion centers on how a future workplace is chosen (not really an ethical dilemma).

Exercise flow

- Students read what a value is
- Students select 20-25 values from a list of values
- Students choose values that might influence the choice of a future job
- Students share with a group of 3-6 two of the values that would influence a job choice and why
- Students reflect on how others choices were different from their own

Preparation:

Read the entire module. Print out enough copies of student handouts for entire class. Handout is attached at the end.

If this module is to be presented online

See online addendum. Student go through the same assignment, post their top two values that they have put W's next to and describe how that value would influence a job choice for them. Next, the students need to read each other's posts and discuss anything that surprised them.

Side note:

In this module, students are asked to openly discuss their personal values. To encourage authentic engagement with the material and each other, you may need to state some guidelines on expectations of peer-to-peer interaction. Here are two suggestions from "Guidelines For Classroom Interactions", the Center for Research on Learning & Teaching, University of Michigan, <http://crlt.umich.edu/examples-discussion-guidelines>.

1. Understand that your words have effects on others. Speak with care. If you learn that something you have said was experienced as disrespectful or marginalizing, listen carefully and try to understand that perspective. Learn how you can do better in the future.
2. Understand that others will come to these discussions with different experiences from yours. Be careful about assumptions and generalization you make based only on your experience. Be open to hearing and learning from other perspectives.

Instructors Guide

Lesson plan for face-to-face: (modifications for online or blended; see online addendum)

Introduction (to be read or summarized to class)

Your experience in college should help prepare you for your next steps in life. That means that you will increase in knowledge. At this university, we also are concerned that you learn to apply that knowledge in a way that is beneficial to society. Sometimes it is hard to decide what will be beneficial and what will not. To that end you will be presented with opportunities to learn about ways to approach decision making when faced with an ethical dilemma and to practice using those approaches. This short exercise will ask us to think about what we value and apply that knowledge to decision-making. In later modules, we will learn about different frameworks for understanding societal values (aka ethics) and practice using them in making ethical decisions.

Activity

- Distribute the values handout to students.
- Instruct students to read the definition of what a value is. Ask one or more students to define “value” in their own words. (3 minutes)
- Instruct students to circle their top 20-25 values from the list of values provided (3 minutes)
- When most students are finished (2-3 minutes), instruct students to put a W next to the circled values that might inform where they would choose to work when they graduate.
- When most students are finished (1-2 minutes), instruct students to form groups of 3-6. Ask each student to share with their group 1-2 of their values labelled with a W and why that value would influence their work choice. Provide an example. One example might be that flexibility is important so that student might not want to work for a company that requires strict start and finish times.

Reflection (to be completed in class)

Ask each group to report to what degree answers differed within the group (2-5 minutes)

Ask several students to share with the class an answer provided by a groupmate that surprised them or caused them to reconsider what values might be important in choosing a future work place. (2-5 minutes)

Ask students if they can think of an example where it would be important to understand the values of others. One example might be if a person on a team valued punctuality and the team meetings always started late. That could cause irritation on the part of the punctual team member. (2-5 minutes)

Assessment (to be included later on a quiz, paper, or exam to determine if learning objectives were reached)

- What is a value?
 - Students will probably refer to one of the definitions given on the handout

- Why is it important to understand what we value?
 - Understanding what we value can help in deciding between choices
- Why is it important to understand what others value?
 - Understanding what others value can help make teams more cohesive, help make products better, demonstrate respect, etc.
- Give an example of a choice in your life that reflects one (or more) of your values.

Values Survey

Please fill out questions 1-3.

What is a value?

“A value is something you are willing to act on” Ayn Rand, philosopher

“Values are a matter of what guides you through every day, every task, every encounter with another

human being.” Richard Bolles, What Color is Your Parachute

“a preference that is felt and/or considered to be justified – morally, by reasoning, or by aesthetic judgments, usually by two or all three of these” Sarah Spiekermann: Ethical IT

Question 1: Write the definition of “value” in your own words:

Question 2: Identify your values: Begin by circling the values in the list below that are most important to you. (One way to start to do this is to look back on your life to identify when you felt good or confident about a choice. For example, learning to play a sport, instrument or some other skill that involve practice- then maybe you value physical activity, competition or challenge.) Try to choose 20-25 top values.

{{% multicolumn %}}

Achievement

Advancement

Adventure

Appreciation

Attentiveness

Authenticity

Autonomy

Balance

Beauty

Being the best
Belonging
Challenge
Compassion
Competition
Consistency
Contentment
Creativity
Curiosity
Decisiveness
Dependability
Dignity
Diversity
Education
Enjoyment
Entrepreneurship
Environmental Protection
Equality
Fame
Family
Financial security
Flexibility
Freedom
Fun
Generosity
Gratitude
Growth
Happiness
Harmony

Health
Honesty
Hospitality
Humility
Humor
Inclusivity
Individuality
Independence
Influence
Innovation
Integrity
Intelligence
Justice
Kindness
Leadership
Leisure
Listening
Love
Loyalty
Making a difference
Mastery
Mercy
Open-mindedness
Originality
Patriotism
Peace
Physical activity
Power
Privacy

Problem solving

Professionalism

Punctuality

Quality

Recognition

Relationships

Reliability

Resourcefulness

Respect

Rigor

Risk-taking

Safety

Security

Sensitivity

Self-expression

Service

Simplicity

Spirituality

Stability

Status

Success

Teamwork

Tenacity

Tolerance

Transparency

Trustworthiness

Usefulness

Vision

Wealth

{{% /multicolumn %}}

Question 3: After you have circled your 20-25 top values, put a W next to the circled values that might inform where you would choose to work when you graduate.

When everyone in your group has finished, each person should choose two of the values that they have put W's next to and describe to the group how that value would influence a job choice for you.

Online Alternative Values Survey

On your own, complete questions 1 – 3.

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Dignity
Diversity
Education
Enjoyment
Entrepreneurship
Environmental Protection
Equality
Fame
Family
Financial security
Flexibility
Freedom
Fun
Generosity
Gratitude
Growth
Happiness
Harmony
Health

Honesty
Hospitality
Humility
Humor
Inclusivity
Individuality
Independence
Influence
Innovation
Integrity
Intelligence
Justice
Kindness
Leadership
Leisure
Listening
Love
Loyalty
Making a difference
Mastery
Mercy
Open-mindedness
Originality
Patriotism
Peace
Physical activity
Power
Privacy
Problem solving

Professionalism

Punctuality

Quality

Recognition

Relationships

Reliability

Resourcefulness

Respect

Rigor

Risk-taking

Safety

Security

Sensitivity

Self-expression

Service

Simplicity

Spirituality

Stability

Status

Success

Teamwork

Tenacity

Tolerance

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Trustworthiness

Usefulness

Vision

Wealth

Question 3: After you have circled your 20-25 top values, put a W next to the circled values that might inform where you would choose to work when you graduate.

Question 4: Post two of the values you placed a W by and write two sentences about how those values would influence a job choice for you.

(Questions 5- 6, can be completed in a discussion board format or individual assignment)

Question 5: Read the posts from other students in the class. Find a post that is similar to your values. Find a second post, that is different than your values. State how they are different and similar. Does either post surprise you why or why not?

Question 6: Consider the two posts you cited in question five. If you worked with the individual with the post similar to yours, what might be the benefits of working with this person? What could be the deficits?

If you worked with the individual with the post different to yours, what might be the benefits of working with this person? What could be the deficits?

*If your course is a blended format, you could follow up in class with question 6 as a small group discussion.

Bibliography